Evidence of Teaching Effectiveness

Zheyuan (Kevin) Cui
Princeton University kevin.cui@princeton.edu kevin-zheyuan-cui.github.io

I have taught as a preceptor at Princeton since Fall 2023, leading my own weekly sections (precepts) in Introduction to Macroeconomics and in Chinese Financial and Monetary Systems, a course cross-listed for undergraduate and graduate students. At the end of each term, the students in every precept section rate the overall quality of their precept on a scale from 1 (Poor) to 5 (Excellent). Below I compare the ratings of my sections with the average across all precept sections of the same course and term, and I report the comments my students wrote about my precepts.

Ratings relative to the course average

Term	Course	Responses	Difference from course average
Spring 2026	ECO 101 Introduction to Macroeconomics	9	$+0.22$
Spring 2025	ECO 101 Introduction to Macroeconomics	24	-0.05
Spring 2024	ECO 101 Introduction to Macroeconomics	11	$+0.46$
Fall 2023	ECO 101 Introduction to Macroeconomics	24	0.00
Fall 2023	ECO 494 Chinese Financial and Monetary Systems	2	$+0.50$
Fall 2023	FIN 594 Chinese Financial and Monetary Systems	5	$+0.30$

Notes: each entry is the mean rating of my sections minus the mean rating of all precept sections of the course in that term, in points on the 1–5 scale, from Princeton's course evaluations. ECO 101 was taught by Richard Rogerson in the spring terms and by Henry Shim in Fall 2023. ECO 494 (undergraduate) and FIN 594 (graduate) are the two listings of Wei Xiong's course.

My precepts were rated above the course average in six of the ten sections I have taught and in four of the six course offerings, and in line with it in the other two. My strongest section (ECO 101, Spring 2024) was rated 0.82 points above its course average. Across all terms, 56 percent of the 75 students who rated my precepts rated them Excellent or Very Good.

Student comments on my precepts

Spring 2026, ECO 101

"My preceptor did a great job at helping students through the material. He was usually clear and concise and always quick to respond to questions. It was very rare that he wasn't clear."

"The precepts were good. Kevin was always open to questions and he had an excellent grasp of the content."

"The instructor was very responsive to questions and was helpful in clarifying any confusions. . . "

Spring 2025, ECO 101

"Kevin really helped me learn macroeconomics! He was so helpful in office hours and made precept so easy to understand."

"Precept was great, Kevin did a great job explaining everything and was always very reachable."

"I think that my classes with Kevin Cui were extremely helpful to my understanding of this course and its material."

"Kevin was extremely responsive to my questions and he was always available to clarify course material."

"I really enjoyed the precepts and thought they were super helpful. They dug in deep into what the lectures were teaching."

"They were very helpful and professor Cui was very good at explaining information and being thorough."

"He did a really [good] job at explaining the concepts we learned in lecture in more depth, and was always open to any questions."

"Kevin's precept is very clear and serves as [supplements]/emphasis on important material, which is very helpful in completing the psets."

"Kevin was super helpful during precept! He would elaborately answer all of my questions."

"He was very open to questions."

"The class has been very interesting, going to the precepts has been helpful."

Spring 2024, ECO 101

"Kevin was a very helpful and engaging preceptor and he did a wonderful job explaining concepts, reviewing lecture content, and answering questions."

"Kevin was great. He was really helpful with any questions I had."

"Kevin Cui did a good job explaining material and was helpful for answering my questions."

"He was engaging and very helpful!"

"Good review of the material and solid instruction."

"The classes were good and helped to explain other material taught in lecture."

"I liked Rogerson and many of the preceptors, especially Chanisk Yoon and Kevin Cui. . . " (course-wide question)

Fall 2023, ECO 101

"There were many times that I was interested to learn more on a topic and then we would dive in deeper and examine many different examples. All students felt welcome to ask any questions as there was always a well constructed and informative response."

"The classes helped clarify content that was covered in lecture and understand different ways to approach problems. The instructor always asked if anyone had questions and was prepared to explain various topics when students needed clarification."

"Kevin was a great preceptor—he helped clarify any questions I had on problem sets and his slides were useful for review."

"Kevin was supportive in assisting our learning and helped us try to understand the material completely if anyone was stuck. His precept slides helped a lot for me personally."

"Kevin did a good job supplementing our learnings. He was always open to questions as well."

". . . Kevin was always very prepared and had slides. His review session before the final was very helpful, and he was always willing to answer questions in precept."

"The precept slides were super helpful and explained the material very clearly! The preceptor was very helpful and knowledgable. . . "

"Kevin was super nice and always helped answer any questions."

". . . I think my preceptor was good at answering questions and explaining concepts."

"The quality of classes was excellent."

Comments are quoted as written; square brackets mark corrected typos and ellipses mark omitted text. All comments except the one marked course-wide come from the questions that only the students in my own sections answered.